RESTS (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

Rests let you recover between fights: the **Short Rest** (1 hour) and the **Long Rest** (8 hours).

🎲 Quick summary:

Short Rest	Long Rest
Duration: 1 hour.	**Duration**: at least 8 hours.
Activity: nothing more strenuous than reading, talking, eating, or standing watch.	**Activity**: at least 6 hours of sleep and at most 2 hours of light activity.
Start: at least 1 HP.	**Start**: at least 1 HP.
Benefits: spend Hit Point Dice to regain HP, and recharge some features.	**Benefits**: all HP and all spent Hit Point Dice, HP maximum restored, Exhaustion −1, features recharged. Afterward: wait 16 hours before another Long Rest.

⚠ Incapacitated and Unconscious:

- While sleeping during a Long Rest, you have the **Unconscious** condition.
- **Incapacitated**: no action, Bonus Action, or Reaction. Your concentration is broken and you can't speak. If you are Incapacitated when you roll Initiative, you have Disadvantage.
- **Unconscious**: you are Incapacitated and Prone, you drop what you hold, and your Speed is 0. Attack rolls against you have Advantage, you automatically fail Strength and Dexterity saving throws, and a hit from within 5 feet is a Critical Hit. You are unaware of your surroundings.

⚠ Change from 2014

A Long Rest restores **all** spent Hit Point Dice (half in 2014). You must wait **16 hours** between Long Rests (24 hours in 2014). An interrupted rest has precise rules (next page).

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

A Short Rest is interrupted by initiative, a spell, or damage, but the text also speaks of doing nothing more strenuous than reading or talking. Some tables therefore treat the list as exhaustive, others don't. Fix: the **DM specifies what interrupts a rest**.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe watch shifts, the crackling fire, and the night sounds, so the rest stays a highlight of the game.

Step 1 – Choose and start the rest:

Choose a Short Rest (1 hr) or a Long Rest (8 hrs). You need at least 1 HP to begin it.

Step 2 – Short Rest:

Spend one or more Hit Point Dice: roll each die, add your Constitution modifier, and regain that total in HP (minimum 1). Some features recharge.

Example: Boris (level 3 Fighter, Con +2, d10) spends 2 dice: 6 + 2 and 4 + 2. He regains 14 HP.

Step 3 – Long Rest:

After 8 hours, you regain all your HP and all spent Hit Point Dice, and your Exhaustion drops by 1. You must then wait 16 hours to begin another.

Step 4 – Interrupted rest:

- **Long Rest**: interrupted by initiative, a spell other than a cantrip, any damage, or 1 hour of walking or exertion.
- If you already rested at least 1 hour, you get the benefits of a Short Rest.
- You can resume right away: it then takes 1 extra hour per interruption. Example: 2 interruptions, the Long Rest lasts 10 hours.
- **Short Rest**: interrupted by initiative, a spell other than a cantrip, or any damage. It grants no benefit and must be restarted.

Step 5 – Special cases:

- **Elven Trance**: elves don't sleep. They finish a Long Rest in 4 hours of trancelike meditation, remaining conscious: neither Unconscious nor Incapacitated.
- **Class features**: some recharge on a Short Rest (e.g. the Warlock's Pact Magic, the Wizard's Arcane Recovery, the Fighter's Second Wind).

Table rule: Elven Trance Table rule

During the trance, the elf's Perception is at Disadvantage. On an outside interaction (an attack, etc.), the elf risks only being surprised.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Number of Short Rests

The only hard limit on Short Rests is the hours in a day; story time and interruptions are the practical limits, the DM's call.

Reducing Exhaustion

An effect like *Greater Restoration* can reduce Exhaustion.

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